

allocate their couriers based on that intelligence,” says Praful Poddar, SVP-Product Management at Shiprocket. If a seller has a 70 per cent successful delivery rate, CORE helps that rate improve to 75-80 per cent.

The company helps leading D2C brands improve after-sales service at reduced costs and, in the process, captures millions of data points from multiple transactions across shopping platforms, which it feeds into its indigenous AI system, making it more accurate and useful as time passes. Shiprocket, which handles 10 million shipments per month, says its per order cost across 45 warehouses has halved and delivery times cut by 40-50 per cent since it started using AI analytics for order fulfilment.

More importantly, it helps predict demand and so, “you can store your goods closer to your customer and bring down shipping costs”, says Poddar. Adds A&M’s Saigal: “E-commerce logistics is so dynamic on the demand side that you don’t know where your next order is coming from. Companies are now building AI/ML-led logistics and fulfilment models to cater to demand, which is changing every hour.”

Many logistics companies today use predictive analytics for demand forecasting, route and location mapping, inventory planning, warehouse management, better fleet utilisation, and faster shipments. “The AI can take into account historical data as well as macro trends that are used to plan efficient shipment-fulfilment,” Saigal explains. “Brands themselves are also using AI/ML to optimise sales, plan product and inventory, lower customer acquisition costs, and maximise bang for the buck.”

Some legacy logistics companies, which would earlier fulfil e-commerce orders by carving out a corner of their warehouses designed for

WHILE INDIA MAY
BE FAR AWAY FROM
FULLY ROBOTIC
WAREHOUSES,
SEVERAL **BASIC AND
LOW-EFFICIENCY
JOBS** ARE GETTING
AUTOMATED

